

dian employees are most interested in are AI, IT and tech literacy, data science and analytics, programming and coding, and software project management.

Ramesh Alluri Reddy, CEO of TeamLease Degree Apprenticeship, says to retain talent, investing in skill development is key because India has a very young working population with an average age well below 30 years. "Even senior employees need to be skilled to remain relevant. A lot of companies are now investing in skill development," he notes.

He says many companies reimburse senior employees for any degrees and certifications they get. "For entry-level talent, there are various innovative methods supported by government policies. There is now greater acceptance and usage of apprentices in companies as well as work-integrated

A SURVEY BY CONSULTANCY BCG REVEALED THAT SHOULD COMPANIES NOT MEET EXPECTATIONS, YOUNGER WORKERS ARE WILLING TO VOTE WITH THEIR FEET

learning programmes," he adds.

And it's not just for permanent employees. Several staffing companies that provide temporary workers are also working on reskilling and upskilling these employees.

Suchita Dutta, Executive Director at the Indian Staffing Federation (ISF), says staffing companies, too, are working on upskilling their employees. "For instance, a mechanical fitter will have to upskill

to remain technically knowledgeable and relevant in the case of automation," she points out.

DIVERSITY PLEASE

Recruiters highlight that employees favour employers who reflect their views, values, and take action to improve equity in the workplace.

Randstad's Giri says new trends in hiring include equity, which means equitable opportunities cutting across all segments of talent and marginalised communities, not just women but also people with physical disabilities and the LGBTQ+ community. "The issue is how do we make them comfortable and provide a congenial work atmosphere? For employees with physical disabilities, companies also have to ensure proper access to workspace areas," he adds.

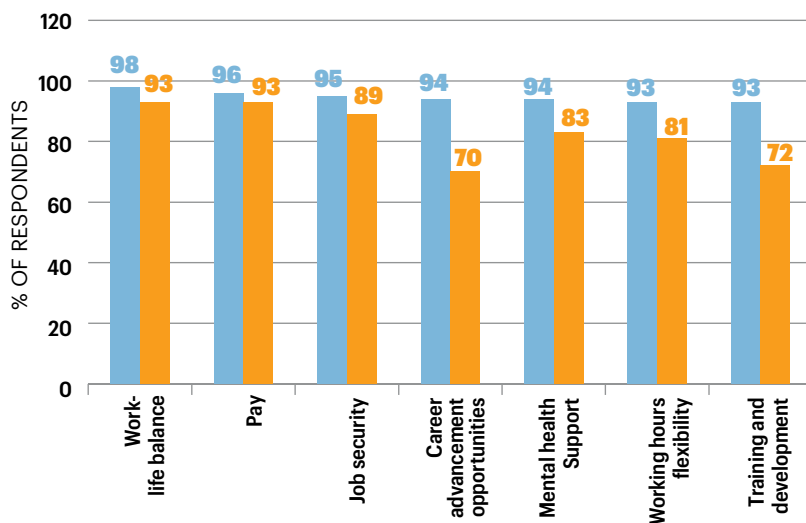
Alok Kumar, President at Manpower, a part of the workforce solutions agency ManpowerGroup, says younger workers are keeping a close eye on which companies celebrate diversity and inclusion. "Workplaces that encourage meritocracy and encourage dialogues to build a healthy and equitable workplace shall be preferred by generations coming into the workforce in this decade," he notes.

With the increasing thrust on hiring women returning from breaks to take up jobs, many firms that traditionally chose to hire men,

FACTORING IN CHOICE

● For millennials, work-life balance is the mantra

● Own happiness, mental health, and personal life priority over employment



● INDIANS ● GLOBAL

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